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M3 - Reflective Essay | Anthropological and Social Perspectives of the Self

Meaningful Social Interactions

At times, I think I put too much pressure on myself to be extroverted. In those instances, I realize that my desire for social interaction is fueled by an intention to avoid appearing cold or indifferent even though I may not be in the right state of mind at the time. There have been occasions where I get caught up on how I'm perceived by others during our interaction, probably being too shy to speak. Despite this, I do appreciate social engagement, especially when I am able to laugh and engage in conversation beyond small talk.

My Assumed Public Image

I believe myself to be both an introvert and an extrovert. On one hand, I can be really vocal with those around me whom I feel comfortable with. But at the same time, I need periods of solitude for myself to recharge and think. Whereas some people may find me to be outgoing, in that I am able to strike up conversation easily, others can see my shy side emerge when I am lost in contemplation or just observing. It is my hope that my ability to switch sides helps me to adapt well in any social situation I might find myself in. Sometimes, however, I worry about how other people perceive my balance between the two types of personality.

External Perceptions of Me

I don't really think about my public image too often so I asked my friends about how they view me and basically they told me that I "have a good energy" and that I often have that vibe about me. I appreciate that because whenever I view myself or self-reflect it's always negative things, and they remind me that I should appreciate myself more because there are other people that do as well.